

New Minor Forcing

INTERMEDIATE

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New Minor Forcing (NMF)

solves a common problem: after opener rebids 1NT, responder has 11+ points and a five-card major but doesn't yet know whether opener holds three-card support. Bidding the *other* minor — the "new minor" — is an artificial force that asks opener to further describe shape and strength.

The trigger

Opener rebids **1NT** over a one-level major response — showing a balanced hand with 12-14 HCP. Responder then bids the *unbid minor*:

Opener	Responder
1♣	1♠
1NT	2♦ ¹

1. 2♦: New Minor Forcing — artificial and invitational. Says nothing about diamonds.

With this hand, responder wants the best game: 4♠ if

opener has three spades, otherwise 3NT.

♠	A Q 9 5 4
♥	K 7 3
♦	A 5
♣	J 8 4
14 HCP	

Opener's rebids

Opener answers the question — cheaply with 12 or 13 HCP, or with a jump with 14 HCP:

Opener's rebids after 1♣-1♠-1NT-2♦!	
2♥/3♥	Four hearts - top priority
2♠/3♠	Three-card spade support
2NT/3NT	Heart stopper
3♦	4 diamonds
3♣	5 clubs
Jump	With 14 HCP

Putting it together

Opposite three-card support, responder drives to the major-suit game:

Opener	Responder
1♣	1♠
1NT	2♦ ¹
2♠ ²	4♠

1. 2♦: New Minor Forcing
2. 2♠: Three-card spade support, 12-13 HCP

Remember

- NMF is **only** on after a **1NT rebid** by opener — not after every 1NT.
- The new minor promises **nothing** in that minor; it is pure convention.
- Responder needs at least invitational values. Weaker hands pass 1NT or sign off in a suit instead.